B2 Listening

Following an interview

Follow a radio interview: separate the questions from the answers, and catch the speaker's reasons and examples.

In an interview, the presenter's questions tell you what is coming next. Use them as signposts, then listen for the guest's main answer, the reason behind it and an example.

Listen for	Typical language
The question (topic)	*So what made you...? How did you...? What would you say to...?*
The main answer	*Basically,... The main thing was... I'd say...*
Reasons	*because, the reason is, that's why, mainly due to*
Examples	*for instance, like, take... for example*
Advice or future plans	*My advice would be... Next year we're hoping to...*

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Presenter: With me today is Leila Haddad, who left her job in banking to open a bakery. Leila, what made you change careers? Leila: Honestly, I was tired of spending twelve hours a day in front of a screen. Baking had always been my hobby, and I wanted to do something with my hands. Presenter: Was it difficult at first? Leila: Very. For the first six months, I worked every day and hardly made any profit. The hardest part was finding good staff. Presenter: And now? Leila: Now we have two shops and eleven employees. Our date and cardamom bread is the most popular thing we make. Presenter: What would you say to someone thinking of doing the same? Leila: My advice would be to start small. I began by selling at a weekend market, so I knew people liked my products before I spent a lot of money.

Predict from the question. When you hear *Was it difficult at first?*, expect a yes or no, then a problem. Write the problem, not the whole answer.

Common mistake. Writing down the presenter's words as the answer. Exam questions ask what the *guest* says, and the guest often corrects or adds to the presenter.

Practice

1. What was Leila's job before?
2. Give one reason she changed careers.
3. What was the hardest part at the start?
4. How many shops and employees does she have now?
5. What is her most popular product?
6. What is her advice, and how did she follow it herself?

▼ **Show answers**

1. She worked in banking.
2. She was tired of working twelve hours a day at a screen. (or: she wanted to work with her hands)
3. Finding good staff
4. Two shops and eleven employees
5. Date and cardamom bread
6. Start small; she sold at a weekend market first.